



Womens Athlete Programme
5 x Per Week

Welcome To The Athlete Programme 5x A Week

If you wish to go to the gym 5 times a week, have been training for a while, and want to take your body to an elite level, I suggest you try out this programme. It will teach you how to train to an advanced level, and you will learn what your body is capable of, and when to give yourself a rest.

Use the advanced programme to push yourself, and find your limits. This is high level peak training for a natural lifter, representing the top end of what is recoverable and sustainable, especially if you are an athlete combining sessions with sports each week, this represents a very high overall training load.

This Is A Challenging Programme

Aim for 70 - 80% adherence to this programme. This means you can reduce the number of sets, miss cardio here and there, and swap out certain styles of cardio for easier ones depending on how you feel. At this stage listening to your body is important. IF you feel tired, if you feel pains start to build, you have to use your intuition when training at an advanced level.

This is an elite programme, if you follow it even 70 - 80% you will see some of the greatest progress you have ever seen to your body. You are training like a athlete whilst considering aesthetics. This is a challenging programme and what we are setting you is the "ideal" week, which you then regulate based on what you can manage. Don't worry if you don't stick to the workouts 100% all the time, there is some flexibility encouraged with such an advanced level programme.





1 Year Of Programming

This is a year of programming for a 5 times a week Athlete programme for women.

Goals Of Program:

Designed to aesthetically improve your body composition rapidly and build a strong, pain free base for sports and everyday life, with good posture.

Training Approach:

This program uses a UPPER LOWER split approach where lower body exercises and upper body exercises are split into different workouts. There are 3 Lower and 2 Upper workouts a week.



Who Is This For?

If you want to work out 5 times a week and build a stronger and better looking body, this is for you.

If you have over an hour to workout 5 times a week, then this is for you.

If you are looking to be strong, pain free, work on your posture, and build a strong foundation, this is for you.

If you want to build a top 10% physique, this is for you.

If you want to build your body aesthetically whilst playing sports at the same time, this is for you.

If you are willing and able to put in the time, and want to maximise an aesthetic body by training hard 5 times a week, this is the way to go.

How This Program Works

Welcome to the AG4 Advanced programme.

In this program, each day is designed to improve the look of your body and improve your speed power, mobility and agility athletically.

Your workouts should take around an hour. Cardio on top will extend the workouts over an hour and is optional, but try to adjust your lifestyle so that you are at least doing 7,000 - 10,000 steps per day if you choose not to do formal cardio.

If you have a very low step count job, then it is advisable to perform 15 - 30 minutes of cardio after your workout if possible for maximum results.

If you play sports, you may have to miss days or replace your daily cardio with cardio from participating in your sports training session.

Equipment Required

- A gym membership.
- A set of resistance bands.
- A set of mini resistance bands.

Video Guidance

Press the  button next to the exercises to access the video form of the exercises if you need help.



Advanced AG4 Program — 5 Days Per Week (Female)

Upper/LowerSplit · Mon–Fri · Repeating Weekly

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
SESSION	AG4 Upper Body 1 — Hypertrophy	AG4 Lower Body 1 — Hip Thrust Focus	AG4 Lower Body 2 — RDL Focus	AG4 Upper Body 2 — Speed	AG4 Lower Body 3 — Paused Squat Focus
WARM UP	AG Push Day Warm Up	AG Light Legs Warm Up	AG Light Legs Warm Up	AG Push Day Warm Up	AG Light Legs Warm Up
ABS	Select from Abs Library	Select from Abs Library	Select from Abs Library	AG Speed Abs	Select from Abs Library
CARDIO	Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	AG Speed Cardio — sprints / speed movements	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming

* At the advanced level, apply 3–5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

Warm ups, the types of cardio, and the abs library will be explained in later pages. For now take a look at the timetable and visualise the programme.

How Many Days Per Week?

If you workout 5 days a week this consists of 3 Lower Body sessions and 2 Upper. There is also room to do 4 days a week by removing a Lower Body Session (2 Lower 2 Upper) and finally if you wish to workout 6 days a week you can add an active rest day where you do a sport, an exercise class, some mobility work or a run.

For working out any amount under 4 days a week, I suggest you look at my Intermediate Full Body programs for women instead. You could attempt 2 Lower and 1 Upper on this programme for 3 days a week, but the Full Body alternatives and Lower Only alternatives for 3 days are specifically faster ways to target the Full Body more or the Lower body more depending on your goals. These also work well for busy athletes that only want to strength train 3 days a week. 5+ days will get you the most aesthetic results if you can stick to the programme, but 3 days is better if you would struggle to hit the 5 due to conflicting sports sessions or life events. 3 days may result in slower muscle growth, but it is still a great option.

This programme has options, people think they want a “5 day a week programme” but the truth is, you’ll have weeks where you may end up doing 4 days or weeks where you want to do more. This is why a programme that lets you breathe with options such as this programme is important. Learning how to drop off a day and which one to drop off is important.

Therefore this programme actively supports 4, 5, and 6 days a week.

Applying Advanced Training Techniques

Welcome to the AG4 Advanced programme.

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Warm Ups

Lower Body Warm Up



5 Minute Warmup On Treadmill

Bodyweight Squats With Toe Taps:

After every squat lift your leg up to chest height and touch your right toe against your left hand. Then the next squat touch your left toe to your right hand. Bring your legs as high as flexibility allows.

Hold A Hip Flexor Stretch (A very deep leaning forward lunge where your back knee is 1 inch from the floor) for 15 seconds each Leg.

Upper Body Warm Up

Band Pass Throughs: Pass the band behind your head and pass it slowly around your back, trying not to touch your back. You should pass the band to around chest height behind you, and pull it apart gently.

Do the movement slowly over the course of 5 seconds. Then bring it back. This works your stabiliser muscles and increases your shoulder mobility.

Band Pull Aparts: Pull a resistance band apart at chest level. Keep your triceps locked out and don't bend at the elbows. You can do this with dumbbells too, but due to the gravity and resistance a resistance band provides, it is better to use bands. Do one set overhand and one set underhand.

Arm Circles: Hold your arms out to the side and then move them in circles. 15 seconds forwards and 15 seconds backwards. Increase the size of the circles as you go.

AG4 Upper Body 1 (Hypertrophy)

AG WOMENS • ADVANCED PROGRAMME

Warm Up: AG Push Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

DB Shoulder Press ▶

4 x 10

Lateral Raises AG Dropset ▶

3 x 15

Lat Pulldown ▶

4 x 15

Row Machine / Cable Row Machine ▶

4 x 15

Rear Delts Machine ▶

3 x 15

Bicep Curls Machine ▶

3 x 12

Triceps Rope Pushdown ▶

3 x 12

Abs – Any Workout From Abs
Exercise Library

Cardio: Zone 5 (Hand Bike and Boxing Bag or
Ski RG and Battle Ropes)

AG4 Upper Body 2 (Speed)

AG WOMENS • ADVANCED PROGRAMME

Warm Up: AG Push Day Warm Up

DB Chest Press ▶

3 x 12

Assisted Pull Ups Machine ▶

3 x 12

Barbell Row ▶

3 x 12

Rear Delts Machine x Face Pulls

Superset ▶

2 x 15

Bicep Curls Machine x Hammer Curls

Superset ▶

2 x 12

Triceps Rope Pushdown x Behind Head

Cable Extension Superset ▶

3 x 12

Abs: AG Speed Abs Workout ▶

Cardio: AG Speed Cardio Day

AG4 Lower 1

AG WOMENS • ADVANCED PROGRAMME

Warm Up: AG Legs Warm Up

Hip Thrust ▶

4 x 12

Squat OR Leg Press ▶

4 x 12

Leg Curl Machine or DB Leg Curl ▶

3 x 15

Leg Extension ▶

4 x 12

Hip Abduction – Leg Cables or Machine ▶

4 x 12

Abs: Back Extension ▶

3 x 12

**Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6
Rounds Punch Bag**

AG4 Lower 2

AG WOMENS • ADVANCED PROGRAMME

Warm Up: AG Legs Warm Up

Romanian Deadlift ▶

4 x 12

Hip Thrust ▶

4 x 12

Leg Press (Pauses) ▶

4 x 12

Lunges ▶

4 x 12

Hip Abductor – Leg Cables or Machine ▶

4 x 12

Abs: Back Extension ▶

3 x 12

**Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6
Rounds Punch Bag**

AG4 Lower 3

AG WOMENS • ADVANCED PROGRAMME

Warm Up: AG Light Legs Warm Up

Squat – Paused ▶

4 x 12

Hip Thrust ▶

4 x 12

Leg Extension ▶

4 x 12

Lunges ▶

4 x 12

Hip Abductor – Leg Cables or Machine ▶

4 x 12

Abs: Back extension ▶

4 x 12

**Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6
Rounds Punch Bag**

Advanced Training Techniques

You will notice on your programme card that it mentions applying 3 – 5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per workout session.

Here are the advanced training techniques:

Drop Sets

On your final set of a marked exercise, instead of stopping when you hit failure, immediately reduce the weight by around 20-30% and keep going. Drop the weight again and repeat for 3 drops total. Aim for 8-10 reps at each drop. You will see a small reduction in reps each time – this is completely normal. This month, look out for the green tick marker on specific exercises and apply this technique to your last set only.

Partial Reps

Partial reps are performed in the lower 25% of the range of motion: short, controlled pulses that maintain constant tension in the muscle. They are used at the end of a set, when full reps are no longer possible, to maximize muscle fatigue. After reaching muscle failure, perform 3 to 5 partial reps before lowering the weight. You can also perform partial reps with each rep of your set, doing 3 partial reps for every repetition. Try both methods often!

Pause Reps

Pause reps involve holding the weight completely still at the most difficult part of the movement—usually at the bottom—for 3 to 4 seconds before continuing. This eliminates momentum, forcing the muscle to work under pure tension. Include a 4-second pause on every repetition. Use a slightly lighter weight than usual to compensate for the increased difficulty.

Slow Reps

Slow repetitions involve controlling each phase of the movement with a tempo of 4 seconds on the lift and 4 seconds on the lowering of the weight. Think: 4 seconds up and 4 seconds down. This method increases time under tension, improves muscle control, and makes the muscle work harder during each repetition. Use this technique on every repetition. Slightly reduce the weight to maintain proper technique and controlled movement throughout the set.

Pre-Exhaust

Pre-Exhaust involves performing an isolation exercise immediately before a compound movement with no rest in between. This fatigues the target muscle first, ensuring it reaches maximum exhaustion during the compound exercise instead of letting other muscles do more work. A classic example is doing leg extensions before squats—your quads will already be burning when you start squatting, forcing the muscle to work harder. There is also Dumbbell Flys before Dumbbell Chest Press, or Lateral Raises before Dumbbell Shoulder Press.

Post-Exhaust

Post-exhaustion is the reverse of pre-exhaustion. You hit the compound movement first to recruit maximum muscle fibres, then immediately follow it with an isolation exercise to finish off the target muscle completely with no rest in between sets. For example, Leg press followed immediately by Leg Extensions ensures the quads are fully worked even after the glutes and hamstrings have taken some of the load in the compound.

Myo Reps

Myo-reps are a training method where you take a set close to failure, then rest for about 5–10 seconds and do 5 more reps. After that, you rest again for 5–10 seconds and do another 5 reps. You repeat this cycle around 3 times, or until you can't keep the reps clean anymore. You can use this technique on your last set of an exercise or every set, experiment with what works for you.

Pyramid Training

Pyramid training means adjusting your weight and reps across 4 sets in a structured pattern. An ascending pyramid starts lighter with higher reps and builds to heavier weight with lower reps — great for warming into a heavy movement safely. A descending pyramid starts heavy and works back down — good for pushing strength early when you are freshest. Rep schemes for upward pyramid: 6 8 10 12. Rep schemes for downward pyramid 12 10 8 6. Squats are a great exercise for this type of training.

Run The Rack

The Run The Rack technique is where you finish your last set, and then keep pulling out the pin and switching to the next lowest weight and you continue doing repetitions without rest, and then every time you fatigue you pull out the pin and go one weight lower until you reach a weight of 0. You can do this on machines by pulling out the pin and setting a lower weight each time, or on the dumbbell rack by picking up a lighter pair of dumbbells until you reach the lowest weight on the dumbbell rack.

Tri Sets

Tri Sets chain three exercises together with no rest between any of them — only the time it takes to move between stations. This is one of the most intense techniques in the library. The idea is to keep switching to a slightly easier exercise as you fatigue, meaning the muscle stays under tension for far longer than a normal set. Hit each exercise to failure and move straight to the next. Only rest once all exercises in the Tri-Set are complete.

AG Lateral Raises Dropset

Do 15 repetitions of Lateral Raises, then pick up a lighter dumbbell and do 15 more repetitions without resting. Then take a minutes rest. Do this Dropset 3 times in total.

Booty Builder 3000

Go on the Hip Abduction Machine. Do 3 sets. Your first set should be normal form. Your second set you should do 7 pulses (partial reps) at the top of the movement.

You know the part where your legs are furthest out and really pushing against the pads?

This is the part that is the hardest part of the machine, and therefore it will get you a lot of growth. Do a set where you do 7 pulses at the top of your repetitions, for 10 repetitions.

In your last set, you will perform static holds at the top of the repetition, for 7 seconds. Hold it in place and then do more repetitions. For 10 repetitions total.

Barbell Hip Thrust – Constant Tension Method

This works well for Barbell Hip Thrusts. Load the barbell with smaller plates. This way there won't be a gap at the bottom of the movement where there is no tension. The barbell will always be pressing against your legs and this will ensure a very hard set with constant time under tension.

Don't use olympic bumper plates for this where a 5kg is the same height as a 20kg, use the normal weight plates and don't use plates larger than 10kg in your stack, because they will be too big to use this method.

You will need to lower the total weight that you usually use for your Barbell Hip Thrust, and this method works best when you do sets of 20. It will burn, but the gains and time under tension you receive using this method will be worth it.

20 Reps Of Growth

1 set of 20 reps on the Hack Squat machine. Even with no weight added to the machine, this is a hard challenge to finish. Or more sets if you are brave enough...

Easy Days

I want to introduce the concept of easy days. We all have jobs or responsibilities. We all have times where our bodies are simply tired. We all have times where we probably won't go to the gym unless it's made to be a simple choice for us. In these situations, you can implement easy days.

These are 30 minute days designed to just get you in the gym to be consistent, they will still grow you, but they are only 3 exercises as not to be intimidating workouts that you have to "figure out" from a long listed timetable.

They are just quick simple days to build into your muscle memory, go in and use these days often when you feel drained. A 30 minute quick and effective workout is better than no workout in nearly all cases despite severe injury, or if you ran a marathon the day before, this fact remains true.

Your Easy Day:

Barbell Squat 3 sets x 10

Assisted Pullups Machine OR Lateral Pulldown Machine 3 sets x 10

Treadmill - As long as you like.

Bring your favorite show, movie or audiobook on your phone and enjoy a low pressure day.

Abs Library

You can learn and pick a variety of ab workouts from this library. This stops you getting bored and gives you the choice to workout how you want when it comes to your abs. The variety also helps your abs to grow by challenging them in different ways rather than doing the same workout all the time. You will feel each workout hit your abs slightly differently.

Abs 1 (Hypertrophy)

5 Minutes of Roman Chair Sit Ups
Or
Abs Machine 3 Sets Of 20

Abs 2 (AG Speed Abs)

4 Sets Of 50 Crunches As Fast As You Can

Advanced circuit version of Abs 2:
Decline Sit Ups x failure
Ab Wheel Rollout x failure
Speed Sit Ups As Fast As You Can x failure
(3 rounds of circuit)

Abs 3 (Bodyweight)

3 sets of 12 Leg Raises
5 L Sit attempts

Abs 4 (Hypertrophy)

Decline Sit Ups with a weight plate until failure
Into Ab Wheel Rollouts until failure
Into Fitness Ball Sit Ups until failure Perform 3 rounds.

Abs 5

Hanging Leg Raises 3 Sets Of 12
Ab Wheel Rollouts 3 Sets Of 12

Abs 6 (Explosive)

Decline Sit Ups (Explosively Pushing
A Barbell Into The Sky) 3 Sets Of 12

Captains Chairs Leg Raises With A Dumbbell
On Your Feet (until failure)

Go as fast as you can on the Captains Chair Leg Raises, do 5 repetitions and then try to launch the dumbbell out of your feet as far as you can each time. Then keep going with the leg raises until failure. Picture each repetition as though you are trying to launch the dumbbell as far as you can.

Abs 7 (Burnout)

Roman Chair Sit Ups 3 x failure
Stability Ball Sit Ups 3 x failure
Medicine Ball V Ups 1 x failure
Decline Sit Ups With BarBell Explosive 3 x failure
Abdominal Curl Machine 3 x 12

Abs 8 (High Reps - Lots Of Growth)

This is a challenging circuit that burns, but it adds size to abs very fast.

Leg Raises 30s
Flutter Kicks 30s
Planks 30s
Plank Ups 30s
(3 Rounds - 6 Minutes Total With No Rest)

Abs 9 (Time Under Tension Circuit)

Arnold's Abs Giant Set

Hanging Straight Leg Raises – 20 reps

Hanging Knee Ups – 20 reps
Crunches – 50
reps

Seated Leg Tucks – 30 reps

Stick Twist – 100 reps

Do not take rest in this set!

Within the AG4 system, you can also do 5 minutes of Abs work from the "6 Pack Shortcuts" accelerator programme found in the programs section. This programme will show you how to progress your abdominal exercises to advanced levels, ensuring you are making your abdominal workouts more difficult each week instead of staying at the same intensity.

Types Of Cardio Explained

In this programme you will notice a few types of cardio on your programme card.

Zone 2 Cardio

This is steady state exercise. To put simply you exercise at around a 6/10 intensity, so a light jog or light use of other cardio machines. This keeps your heart rate in "Zone 2" which is 60 – 70% of your maximum.

Punch Bag

Buy some gloves and do 30 minutes of exercise on a punch bag, learning combos and technique.

HIIT

Do a HIIT workout. You can find these on Youtube or also check out the HIIT workout provided below. For a workout to be HIIT you have to spend at least 10 minutes working at near maximum heart rate, (near 9 / 10 intensity.)

HIIT Workout

HIIT Workout

30s High Knees
30s Burpees
30s Squat Taps
30s Plyo Lunges
30s Mountain Climbers
30s Squat Jumps
30s Jumping Jacks
30s Kettlebell Swings
30s Med Ball Slams
30s Plank Jacks
(2 rounds)

Make sure you go to max effort on each exercise to make up a minimum of 10 minutes max effort. If you wish to workout for 30 minutes, you can spend 20 minutes after doing some light cardio or jogging, but ensure you do 10 minutes of max effort first.



Click to watch workout video

Speed Cardio

This programme has cardio days that will help you to become a better athlete should you play sports or partake in exercise classes.

Speed is one of the attributes we work on in this programme in order to make you a better athlete.

Speed is about moving fast and performing an exercise as fast as you can.

Beginners Speed Cardio Workout

5 speed squats
30s light high knees (active rest) (Repeat this combination 5 times and move on)
5 speed burpees
30second skipping on the spot (Repeat this combination 2 times and then move on)
5 speed left hand punches
5 speed right hand punches
30 seconds marching on the spot (Repeat combination 3 times and move on)
Shadowboxing Fast Punch Flurries 5 seconds 30 seconds light high knees
(Repeat this combination 3 times then finish)



Click to watch workout video

Speed Cardio

Advanced Speed Cardio Workout

This is for the more serious athlete, requiring a gym environment and more equipment.

5 speed squats
30s light high knees (active rest) (Repeat this combination 5 times and move on)
5 speed burpees
30second skipping on the spot (Repeat this combination 2 times and then move on)
5 speed left hand punches
5 speed right hand punches
30 seconds marching on the spot (Repeat combination 3 times and move on)
5 reps plyo push ups
30 seconds light skipping on spot (repeat combination 2 times and move on)
Shadowboxing Punch Flurries 5 seconds 30 seconds light high knees (Repeat this combination 3 times and move on)
5 Light Med Ball Slams 20seconds light skipping on spot 30s (Repeat this combination 3 times and move on)
Light Sled Pushes (load 10 – 25% of bodyweight) x 5 sets



[Click to watch workout video](#)

Speed Cardio

Advanced Speed Cardio Workout (Continued)

Optional (Agility Ladder Drills x5sets with 30 second active rest)

Single Leg

Double Leg

In In Out Out

2 Foot In 2 Foot Out Hops

Ali shuffles.

The sled pushes are scientifically proven to improve sprint speed. The speed punches will increase your punching speed for sports such as boxing. The agility ladder will increase your foot speed, and the jump squats will increase your jump speed for sports such as basketball.

You can also replace your Speed Cardio day with x10 max effort 15 second Sprints on a Treadmill or outside, as getting faster at sprints is also a part of Speed Training.



[Click to watch workout video](#)

Zone 5 Cardio

The most intense form of cardio. This goes beyond just high intensity (9/10.) This is max effort, which means the workout is only 10 minutes long if that. Max effort means you cannot possibly be working harder, and when you finish the workout you should be at the point where another repetition is impossible to sustain. The type of cardio where you couldn't possibly continue doing more after.

We have assigned this to once a week, but due to it's intense nature, it is always optional and replaceable with some Zone q or another cardio form of your choice.

However if you are not feeling burned out, it is great to push yourself in this zone.

Examples Of Zone 5

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
45 seconds **active rest** (pedalling slowly)

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
Ski RG 45 seconds **active rest**

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
Punch Bag 45 Seconds Jab Cross Hook Hard As You Can

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Ski RG 15seconds max effort
Punch Bag 45 Seconds Jab Cross Hook Hard As You Can

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Equipment Modifications

This programme is designed around training at a well equipped gym, however here are some common modifications you can make if faced with limitations around specific exercises.

Barbell Exercises – Exercises such as the Barbell Row, Barbell Bicep Curl can be replaced by Dumbbell variations of those exercises.

Dumbbell Exercises – Exercises such as the Dumbbell Shoulder Press and Incline Dumbbell Bench Press can be replaced by Barbell variations of those exercises.

Assisted Pull Up Machine – The first point of call would be to use a heavy resistance band. Use a step or box to give yourself the height required to step into the band, this will help you to do pull ups.

However if this is too challenging, using a bar in a squat rack, set at chest height, can allow you to do Floor assisted Pull Ups where your buttocks and feet touch the floor with your knees bent at the start of every repetition. You can produce the same motion as a pull up. Finally, simply using a bench, a box or another stable raised surface underneath a pull up bar can help you to do Pull Ups. Keep your legs on the raised surface and use them to help you do the pull up by straightening your legs on the way up, and bending your knees on the way down. Select the option that works best for your skill level.

Rear Delt Machine – The Dumbbell Rear Delt Fly can be used as a replacement for this machine. I find the machine smoother and allows me to push to a greater intensity than dumbbells, so to match this without the machine I would use a Superset of Rear Delt Dumbbell Flys (15 reps) straight into Resistance Band Face Pulls (15 reps). This is a solid alternative to work your Rear Delts.

Lateral Pulldown – Hooking a resistance band to a surface above can act as a Lateral Pulldown. Simply doing a Band Pull Apart with a resistance band starting from over your head can also act as a Lateral Pulldown.

Triceps Pushdown / Triceps Behind The Head Extension – Instead of Cables, Resistance Bands attached to an overhead surface such as bar or Squat Rack, make for an excellent alternative for these exercises.

Barbell Squats – Dumbbell Squats or the Leg Press Machine is always an option to replace this exercise.

Deloads

Every 8 weeks take a week where you reduce all set numbers and weights by 50%. Do not see this as a loss of momentum. This is so you can come back the next week harder and refreshed, reducing chances of injury and fatigue. Your lifts should feel fresh as you come back into lifting after the deload week. Don't use them all the time, you still have to workout consistently, but every 8 weeks is an effective use of deloads.

Breaking Plateaus

Implement a heavy day once a week, where you do 4 sets of 5 repetitions at a heavier weight than you would in your 8 - 12 rep range. This helps you build strength if you are struggling to get that extra rep each week in the 8 - 12 rep range. After you reach 3 sets of 12 on an exercise you can go up in weight. If you struggle to add extra reps each week, then 1 heavy day per week can work.

Keep no more than 30% of your weekly work in the strength range (heavy reps of 5 and under) 70% of your work should still come from hypertrophy (8 - 12 rep range).

This gives you the slight transfer of strength necessary to break plateaus for bodybuilding whilst not overtraining your body.

To break a plateau, you can also look up assistance exercises for the lift you are trying to break the plateau on. For example:

Pause Squats, DEEP Hack Squats with a Pause and DEEP Leg Press with a Pause to break a Squat Plateau.

Farmers Carries, Bar Hangs and RDL's to break a Deadlift Plateau.

Lateral Pulldowns, Banded Pull Ups, Pull Up Negatives and Holds for Pull Up Plateaus.

Training For Life

After coming to the end of your year on this programme, you should have gained:

- A solid grasp of how to balance training with physical and mental recovery, knowing when to apply your easy days, and when to go hard.
- An understanding of how to build your body on good programming through advanced bodybuilding and cardio training techniques.
- You should have an idea of the exercises, supersets and “advanced training techniques” that work best for you, and how to break plateaus with heavy days and assistance exercises.

At This Stage You Have Two Options:

Option 1: Continue on this 5 day advanced programme, which is good for periods where you want to work hard to achieve fast growth.

Option 2: Reduce to a 3 or 4 day a week programme, or implement more easy days on this current programme. This option is good if life gets busy, you wish to relax your training, or you have built the body you wanted and just want to maintain it.

You'll find in life that you can't go hard forever. You will wish to train at different intensities at different stages in your life, following periods of hard work and faster growth with periods of relaxed work and slower growth.

When you have built your dream body, it doesn't take as much work or frequency to maintain muscle as it does to build it, so you may wish to drop down to lower amounts of sessions and time in the gym once you build the body you desire.

This makes it easy to work on your body for life. Whether you wish to train for 5 days a week, or cut back to 3 or 4, you have the tools to craft an amazing body.

Read This After Programme Completion

Building From AG – Use AG As A Base

The AG programmes are your base, you can experiment and add your own exercises here and there and make substitutions to find what you enjoy. You can strip things back and make sessions less intense or more intense.

The reason we design year round programmes at AG instead of 16 week programmes like everyone else is because we want to develop consistent programming into your muscle memory and really build techniques over the course of an entire year.

Doing these routines consistently for a whole year makes them stick in your head more and creates a lifestyle around a single routine with no sudden changes like on other programmes.

You Are Now Self Sufficient

You are now self-sufficient with your AG training programmes, which is what we wanted to build within every one of our members.

You could walk into any gym and perform these programmes confidently, knowing how to dial things back on a difficult day and how to push harder when you have more to give. This is something that can be taught through a year of repetition and gradual learning, but it cannot truly be learned in 16 weeks.

You should be proud because you have taken a whole year to learn different advanced techniques month by month, whilst sticking to the same template that you now know off by heart. You know how to expand this template and make it more challenging, and you also know how to make it easier when you need to.

You have built something much more valuable than just a year of workouts. You have learned how to train.

Make Fitness Your Own

At this stage, the world of fitness is yours.

You now have a base of different programmes with options for multiple days per week. Now is the time to keep learning and make these programmes your own if you wish.

Keep the foundation you have used to build your dream body: good programming, progressive training, consistency and the knowledge you have developed over the past year. From there, you can tweak that foundation to make training more fun, target any small weaknesses you feel you have, or help you learn new skills and sports.

There is always something new to learn. Keep educating yourself about fitness, bodybuilding, dieting, flexibility and mobility. There is always something you can improve, and that is part of what makes fitness so rewarding.

You Are The Hero

We wanted to teach you self sufficiency and also teach you to build fitness as a love and passion in your life. A lifestyle that you enjoy by making decisions for yourself too.

Coaching is great, we can all do with coaching! But we also want you to be strong and confident on your own too. We want you to eventually reach a point where you feel confident to take charge and build a great fitness lifestyle for yourself and have coaching as a complement to that, rather than being a person who feels like they couldn't live life without a coach.

The coach isn't the star here, you are the hero. You always have been. You make the decisions, and a coach just facilitates that.

Through our coaching we wanted people to actually see and realise that they aren't "nothing" without a coach, and that they don't need to be over reliant on coaching. We actually wanted people to become their own coaches first and foremost, and learn to use external coaching as a complement to their lives.

After all, it was you that arranged for, paid for, and followed the programme, you arranged for exercises to be swapped if you didn't like them, and selected your programme around the time you had available. It was all 80% you and 20% us. Therefore, go forward and take steps to experiment and build out your perfect routine, find ways to make fitness enjoyable for life, and work with coaching if you wish as a way to complement that.

Hit your protein, eat clean, and continue to learn about fitness, bodybuilding, dieting and flexibility and mobility. Healthy living is for life. There is always something to improve. All the best with your training!

- Coach Tommy

